MIL-B-40006C(IH)
31 March 1977
SUPERSEDING
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27 March 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BUCKLE, GENERAL OFFICERS' BELT, GOLD PLATED

This specification is approved for use by The Institute of Heraldry, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of belt buckle used by General Officers'.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

UU-P-553 - Paper, Wrapping, Tissue

PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard

PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup

MILITARY

MIL-B-1462 - Belt, General Officer

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metals; Test Methods

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22314, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

B-6-3 - Buckle, Belt, General Officers', Gold Plated

(A miniature copy of drawing B-6-3, identified as figure 1, is attached for information only.)

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawings required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activty or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a standard sample of the buckle shall be furnished by the contracting officer and shall be used for matching color and finish only.

3.2 First article sample.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of the buckle shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval. The approval of the first article sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article sample shall be manufactured by the contractor in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production item.

3.3 Materials.- Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Copper base alloy.- The copper base alloy shall be roll polished, free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, nicks, cracks, scratches, segregations and foreign inclusions that will not be removed in later processing. When tested as specified in 4.4.5, the chemical composition of the copper base alloy shall be as specified in table 1.

TABLE 1 Chemical composition.-

Alloy	Copper	Lead (max)	Iron(max)	Zinc	Other(max)
Red brass	84.0 to 86.0	.05	.05	Remainder	.15

3.3.2 Rivets.- The rivets shall be commercial brass tubular rivets

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3.3.3 Solder.- The solder shall be hard (silver alloy) solder having a melting point of not less than 1075 degrees F.

3.3.4 Gold for plating.- The gold for plating shall be 24 karat.

3.3.5 Lacquer.- The lacquer shall be a pale, clear, synthetic lacquer. The use of a pigmented lacquer shall not be permitted.

3.4 Design.- The embossed design of the buckle shall be an exact replica of the design on the Government furnished hubs (see 3.7), from which the contractor's working dies shall be extracted. The working dies shall be tooled and polished to remove any dents, nicks, scratches or other imperfections.

3.5 Construction.- The buckle shall be constructed in accordance with drawing B-6-3. The buckle shall be made from red brass specified in 3.3.1. The coat of arms shall be pierced as shown on figure 2 and shall be dapped to fit the contour of the buckle tongue. Three tubular rivets shall be soldered to the back of the coat or arms. After finishing, the device shall be riveted to the buckle tongue as shown on drawing B-6-3. The embossed wreath shall be dapped to fit the contour of the slotted body and shall have five tubular rivets soldered to the back of the wreath. After finishing, the wreath shall be riveted to the slotted body as shown on drawing B-6-3. The coat of arms shall be centered on the buckle tongue and the embossed wreath shall be centrally aligned on the slotted body. When the tongue buckle is engaged into the slotted body, the tongue buckle shall lie flush within the slotted body and be locked in this position. The center lines of the coat of arms and this wreath shall be aligned.

3.5.1 Stamping, trimming and piercing.- The embossed areas shall be struck in a manner to insure a well defined die struck edge. When applicable, embossed areas shall be trimmed and pierced to the die struck outline. All edges shall be clean and smooth, free from burrs, drag, step and rough edges. The piercing and trimming operations, when applicable, shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the insignia.

3.5.2 Soldering.- All soldering shall be accomplished using solder specified in 3.3.3. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong and free from burned or reduced areas. There shall be no excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, the soldered parts shall not separate.

3.5.3 Riveting.- All rivets shall completely fill the rivet holes and shall be set clean, neat and concentric with the holes without split or ragged edges and excessive buildup.

3.6 Finish.-

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3.6.1 Coat of Arms.- The coat of arms shall have a gold plated satin finish with polished highlights.

3.6.2 Buckle tongue.- The tongue of the buckle shall have a mirror-like polished gold plated finish on the obverse side only and a bright or satin finish on the reverse side.

3.6.3 Wreath.- The wreath shall have a gold plated satin finish with polished highlights on the obverse side only and a bright or satin finish on the reverse side.

3.6.4 Slotted body.- The slotted body shall have a mirror-like polished gold plated finish.

3.6.5 Gold plating.- Gold plating shall be accomplished by electroplating using gold specified in 3.3.4. The use of white metals as an undercoating shall not be permitted. The gold plating shall be uniform, non-porous, continuous and unbroken over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, shaded or blistered plating when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.6.6 Lacquering.- The finished buckles shall be lacquered all over with material specified in 3.3.5, and shall be applied so that the lacquer film, when dry, shall be continuous, level, adherent and free from lint, dust and other inclusions. There shall be no change in appearance of the lacquered surface when tested as specified in 4.4.2, except that the following will be permitted:

(a) A slight overall yellowing of the highlights.

(b) Not more than 2 dark spots, no larger than 1/16 inch diameter, widely distributed on the buckle and not more than three such additonal spots shall be permitted on the edge of the buckle.

When tested as specified in 4.4.3, tissue paper shall not adhere to the lacquered buckle and shall fall free when finger pressure is released.

3.7 Government loaned property.- Hubs for the wreath and the coat of arms shall be furnished by the Government and shall be used for making the contractor's working dies. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), forming dies for the tongue and slotted body shall be furnished by the Government. All tools shall be returned to the Government upon completion of the contract.

3.8 Marking.- The contractor shall stamp his trademark or other identifying mark legibly and inconspicuously on the back of the buckle tongue. There shall be no signs of penetration or unevenness on the surface opposite the marked area. The marking shall not distort any part of the buckle.

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3.9 Workmanship.- Buckles shall be clean, well made and shall meet the acceptable quality level established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification which are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article sample inspection.- When required, inspection and testing of the first article sample (see 3.2), shall be made of a completely fabricated buckle for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance.- Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Inspection of components.-

4.3.1.1 Testing of components.- In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in table II for the test characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1.

TABLE II Testing of components.-

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	Rqm't applicable to lot average	#determ per s/u	Results reported as	Sample Unit
Copper base alloy (1 lb)	Chemical composition	3.3.1	4.4.5	x	2 for each element	Nearest 0.1% for each element	4 oz of material

4.3.1.1.1 Certification of compliance.- Materials listed below may

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be accepted on the basis of the contractor's certificate of compliance for requirements specified in applicable paragraphs of this specification.

Components	Characteristics	Rqm't para
Rivets, tubular, brass	Material identification	3.3.2
Hard solder	Material identification and melting point	3.3.3
Gold for plating	Material identification	3.3.4
Lacquer	Material identification	3.3.5

4.3.1.2 In-process inspection.- Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements.

Requirement, operation or assembly	Rqm't para
Gold plating of coat of arms	3.6.1
Soldering of rivets to back of wreath and coat of arms	3.5
Gold plating of wreath	3.6.3
Thickness of metal for coat of arms and wreath	B-6-3

4.3.2 Inspection of the end item.-

4.3.2.1 Visual examination of the buckle.- The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.2.1.1 and 4.3.2.1.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.3.2.1.3. The unit of product for these examinations shall be one buckle.

4.3.2.1.1 Visual examination.- Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the following classification of defects. Examination shall be made at a distance of 16 to 18 inches with lumination equal to average daylight and arranged so as to avoid reflected light as much as possible. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
Color and finish	Color and finish of buckle does not compare favorably with the approved sample	-	*	-
	Pits, scale, pinholes, crack, rupture, segregation or foreign inclusion	-	*	-
	Buff, drag or cloudy finish	-	*	-
	Plated area cut-through, shaded, peeled, blistered, not continuous, broken or porous	-	*	-
	Not lacquered	x	-	-
	Foreign matter embedded in finish, i.e., lint, dust, etc	-	*	-
	Lacquer coating hazy, rainbow effect, cloudy or powdering	-	*	-
	Lacquer not smooth, not continuous or not adherent, i.e., flaking, blistering, peeling or has run or sag	-	-	x
	Lacquer not set to touch, i.e., tacky when gentle pressure is applied to coating	-	-	x
Design	Construction or design details altered or obscrued or not conforming to Government hub	x	-	-
	Any detail struck over resulting in double impression	-	*	-
	Any significant detail not clear, marred, missing, reduced or obliterated, i.e., does not compare favorably with approved sample	-	*	-
	Any area not pierced as indicated by figure or approved sample	x	-	-
Workmanship	Metal marks such as nicks, cracks, dents, digs, gouges or scratches	-	*	-
	Not trimmed to die-struck edge	-	-	x
	Die-struck edge not well defined	-	-	x
	Any sharp or rough edge, burr, drag or step	-	*	-
	Coat of arms or wreath not closely dapped to fit contour of tongue or slotted body, as applicable	-	*	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
	Any component missing, bent, twisted, broken, deformed or otherwise impaired.....	-	*	-
	Coat of arms or wreath is not securely riveted to buckle, i.e., rivet is missing, loose, poorly or insufficient peened.	x	-	-
	Any rivet not tubular, ragged edges, split or not concentric.	-	-	x
	Piercing not clean and smooth....	-	*	-
	Piercing operation distorts coat of arms or wreath.....	-	*	-
	Component parts not completely joined by solder.....	-	*	-
	Any area burned or reduced in soldering or acid cleaning.....	-	*	-
	Soldered area not clean and not smooth, i.e., flux or excess solder not removed.....	-	*	-
	Penetration of marking to opposite surface, unevenness, or distortion.....	x	-	-
Assembly	Centerline of coat of arms and wreath out of alignment.....	x	-	-
	Tongue buckle does not lie flush within the slotted body or tongue buckle not locked in slotted body.....	x	-	-
Marking	Missing illegible, incorrect or incomplete.....	-	-	x

4.3.2.1.2 Examination of the buckle for defects in dimensions.- Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.2.1.3 Inspection levels and AQL's.- The inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	Total
For defects applicable to 4.3.2.1.1	I	.065	2.5
For defects applicable to 4.3.2.1.2	S-3	(one class)	4.0

4.3.2.2 Testing of the end item.- Testing of the completely fabricated insignia shall be performed in accordance with table III

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for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit shall be one buckle. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. Requirements are applicable to the individual unit.

TABLE III Testing of end item.-

Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	#determ per sample unit	Results rptd as
Acid test for gold plating	3.6.5	4.4.1	1	Pass or fail
Tests for lacquer:				
Liver of sulfur	3.6.6	4.4.2	1	Pass or fail
Tackiness test	3.6.6	4.4.3	1	Pass or fail
Test for soldered joints	3.5.2	4.4.4	3 (Coat of arms/wreath only)	Pass or fail

4.3.3 Examination for count of buckle in intermediate containers.- Buckles packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (intermediate container). The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers. Any box containing less than the specified marked quantity of buckles shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per sample units.

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or taping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers
Content	Number of intermediate packages is more or less than required.

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4.4 Tests.-

4.4.1 Acid test for gold plating.- Pieces selected for this test shall be unlacquered or have the lacquer completely removed with an organic solvent and have drops of the test acid applied. A drop of testing acid (each drop to be 1/8 inch in diameter minimum) shall be applied on three different spots on front face of th buckle and the drops allowed to remain for not less than 2 minutes. A minimum of two spots must withstand the acid test. Any visible chemical action, such as evolution of gas, within that time shall be evidence of porous cut-through or peeled, blistered or insufficient plating and failure to meet requirements specified in 3.6.5. The test acid applied at room temperature (60 to 80 degrees F.) shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of chemically pure nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water.

4.4.2 Liver of sulfur test.- Buckles shall be immersed in a 2 percent by weight CP liver of sulfur (sulfated potash) water solution, at a temperature of 100 degrees F., plus or minus 10 degrees F., for a period of 3 minutes. The insignia shall then be removed and rinsed in warm, then cold, then hot water. Insignia shall be wiped gently with an absorbent cellulose material or whirled to remove residual moisture and shall be air dried at room temperature (60 to 80 degrees F.) for 1 hour. The insignia shall then be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.6.

4.4.3 Tackiness test.- At room temperature (60 to 80 degrees F.) press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surface for 15 seconds, using any pressure capable to being exerted between thumb and two fingers, after which, the pressure shall be released and the insignia inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.6.

4.4.4 Tests for hard soldered joints.- Hard soldered joints to be tested shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1065 degrees F., plus or minus 5 degrees F., for not less than 15 minutes. While at the specified temperature, the items shall be lifted by the coat of arms, wreath or soldered edge and the soldered joints examined for compliance with 3.5.2.

4.4.5 Chemical composition test.- Chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with the requirements specified in 3.3.1.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.-

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5.1.1.1 Unit package.- Each buckle shall be completely inclosed in a wrap of not less than three thickness of anti-tarnish tissue paper conforming to type II, grade A, class 1 of UU-P-553. Ends of the wrap shall be folded back to prevent unwrapping. Each wrapped buckle shall be packaged in a set-up paperboard box conforming to vareity 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Inside dimensions of the paperboard box shall be 3-1/2 inches in length, 2-1/2 inches in width and 7/8 inch in depth.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging.- Sixty buckles packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be placed flat, three in length, four in width and five deep in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to type SF, class Domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2 Level C.- Insignia shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving station. The supplier may use his standard practice, when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level C.

5.2.1 Level C.- Buckles packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to assure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rates for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules and regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The buckle covered by this specification is used with the general officer's belt specified in MIL-B-1462.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) When a standard sample will not be furnished (see 3.1).

(c) When a first article is not required (see 3.2).

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(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

(e) When forming dies for tongue and slotted body will not be furnished unless otherwise specified (see 3.7).

Custodian:	Review Activities:	User Activities:	Preparing Activity:
Army IH			GL
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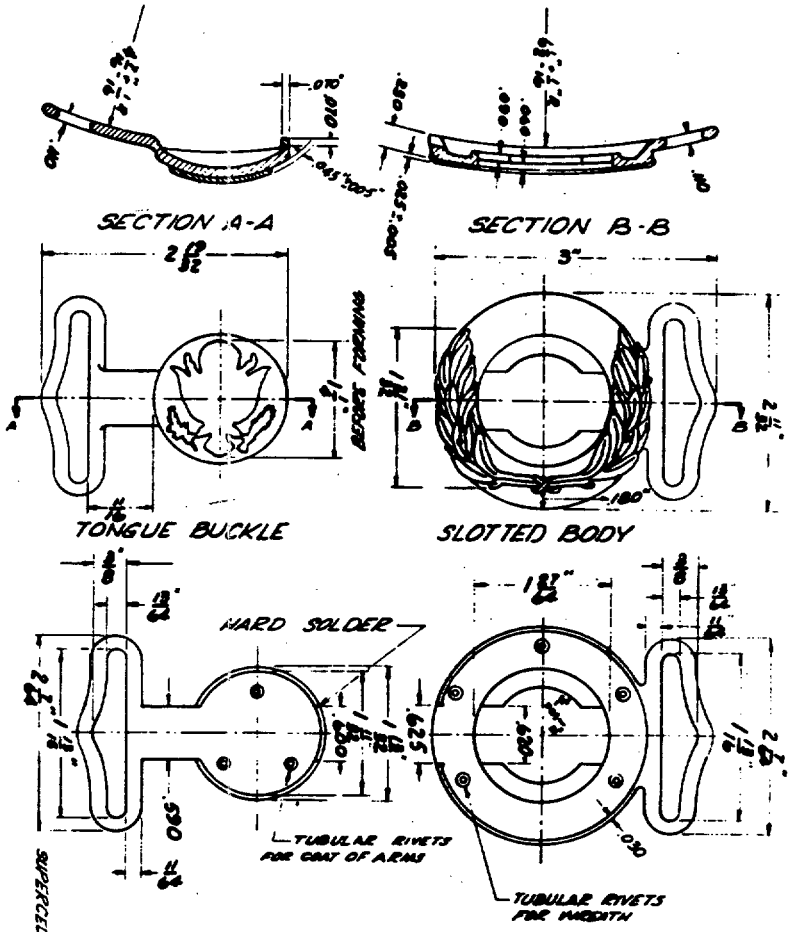


FIGURE 1

TOLERANCES:

UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED THE FOLLOWING TOLERANCES SHALL APPLY:

MATERIAL THICKNESS — ±.010

ALL OTHER DECIMAL DIMENSIONS — ±.015

FRACTIONAL DIMENSIONS ARE REFERENCE DIMENSIONS CONTROLLED BY THE GOVERNMENT FURNISHED HUBS AND DIES AND ARE INCLUDED FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY.

FOR ILLUSTRATION OF EAGLE SEE TION DWG NR B-6-6

SUPERCEDES MATICK DWG'S NR'S 9-1-160 & 9-1-161 DTD 15FEB 60

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY, U.S. ARMY
CAMERON STATION ALEXANDRIA, VA. 22314

BUCKLE, GENERAL OFFICER BELT, GOLD PLATED

SIZE B | CONFIDENT NO 22571 | B-6-3

SCALE 1-1 DATE 15 FEBRUARY 1960

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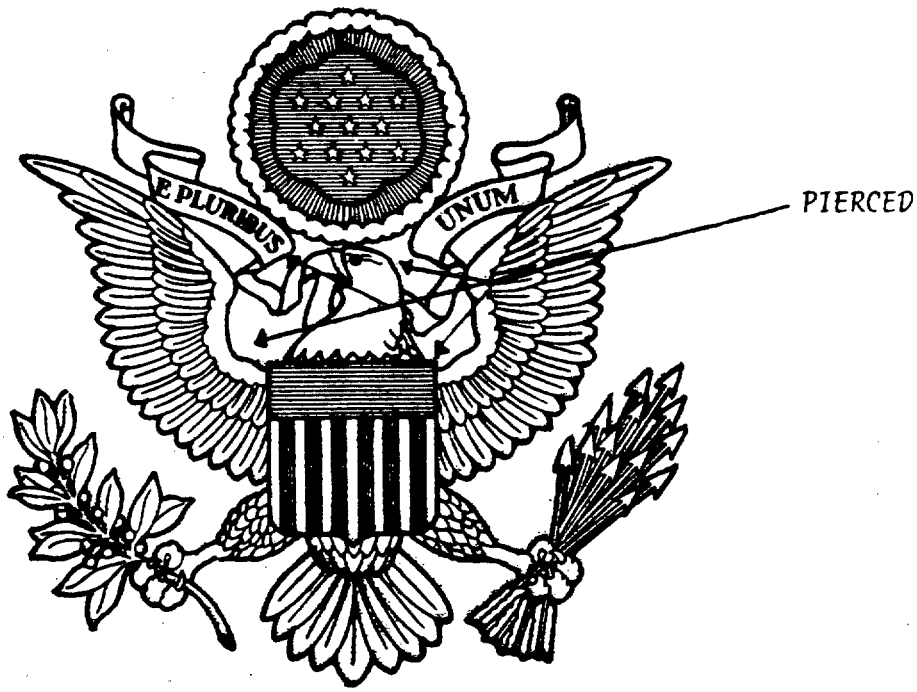


FIGURE 2

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